An Art Director's Viewpoint

Advertising Age, December 23, 1968

How to Get a Woman's Attention: Ignore Her

By Stephen Baker

The man-woman situations depicted in the Silva Thins commercials are selling cigarets by the millions.

In case you haven't watched television lately, these are the commercials which have slight masochistic overtones. There is this long bony character who wears no smile and dark glasses; who seems to be very preoccupied, as if in a daze; who loves his "Impossible Cigarets" so much that he prefers them to even the most beautiful girls.

Stephen Baker

He likes cigarets and hates women so much, in fact, that he forsakes the latter on deserted highways, ocean liners, cable cars, mountain tops, penthouse apartments and anywhere else if the girls as much as dare to touch his cigarets. He is the epitome of the modern male-on-the-prowl who picks his women the way you'd pick your hors d'oeuvre off a smorgasbord table; they are merely to satisfy his momentary appetite. He is obnoxious, arrogant and quite possibly incurably selfish, but he executes his rude antics with admirable eloquence.

This infuriating oaf may yet go down in marketing history as one of the most brilliant creations of advertising pundits. Obviously, viewers of either sex—and particularly the young—enjoy vicariously the adventures of the Silva Thins man.

Women (an important market for this cigaret) especially dig the scene of "The Impossible Cigaret." Psychologically, they seem to feel right at home with the situations. They quite willingly put themselves in the place of the suffering heroine.

Puts Women Where They Want to Be

The makers of this campaign demonstrate a shrewd insight into the emotional make-up of today's woman. Using what appears to be a masculine approach in their advertising, they are reaching the very core of their feminine audience. The hero in the Silva Thins commercials appears to be just what the doctor ordered. His strength lies in his aloofness. Ignoring practically every rule of etiquette, he summarily puts his girlfriend in her place, and exactly where so many women would unconsciously like to be.

The Silva Thins commercials, bold as they may be in their approach, are an open proclamation to the American public that it's still the male who rules the roost, or should be. Here the woman is presented with a boyfriend figure who dominates instead of being dominated. While he makes no attempt to make out with her—in fact if anything he takes the opposite tack—he establishes a relationship that pleases her feminine instinct.

It will be interesting to watch the sales of Silva Thins continue to climb. The fact that concurrently another cigaret, Virginia Slims, is trying to reach the female market with its "For-Women-Only" cigaret makes things even livelier. Our guess is that the appeal of Virginia Slims—which claims that its cigaret is made for women to permit them to assert their independence at last—will not be as successful as that of "The Impossible Cigaret."

It's easy to change cigarets. It's not so easy to change the fundamental psychology of women. #

Silva Thins character may go down in marketing history, says Steve Baker.

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San Diego, Calif.
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San Diego Union
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AUG 23 '71

Allen & Dexter, Inc.

OUR READERS WRITE

Clean Politics

In my view, Proposition 5 doesn't go far enough. If we are really serious about air pollution control, I think we should attack as many problem areas as reasonably possible in one swell foop (sic).

Why not, for example, require that all persons who use public transportation (exclusive of taxicabs) carry on their person proof that they have had a shower and-or bath within six hours prior to boarding said form of public transport, or carry a doctor's affidavit certifying that they are mortally allergic to soap and water?

Also, a heavy fine should be imposed on persons riding elevators who have not brushed their teeth or used an approved mouthwash within a two-hour period or who have partaken of foods known to produce gas or alcoholic beverages (other than vodka) in the previous 24 hours.

The possibilities are almost limitless and Proposition 5 would seem hardly a ripple on the surface.

JOHN L. VANDEGRIFT
San Diego

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"Among criticisms made by scientists of this study are:

"1. A mere numerical association such as Drs. Hammond and Horn claim does not establish any cause and effect relationship.

"2. The survey is limited to smoking habits and therefore does not rule out any number of possible other factors in present-day living that may influence death rates.

"3. The survey is shown to be non-representative of the national population.

"4. The small number of deaths from lung cancer -- at most, 285 out of 8,105 deaths -- makes questionable any conclusions drawn, especially since the sampling methods of the survey are not statistically sound.

"Statistical studies of this nature can at best indicate areas that require study. This has been done, and scientists devoted to such study have recently reported their inability to identify any cancer-causing substance in tobacco smoke derivatives.

"It would be tragic if an over-publicized allegation that lacks scientific support were to divert and impede public or private support of sound research in such an important field of health."

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Cancer Scare, Production Increase Reduce Domestic Cigarette Sales

A development within the United States which directly affects the sale of our tobacco this year is mainly the further decline in the domestic consumption of cigarettes due to the lung cancer scare and other adverse factors major tobacco companies have announced.

Tobacco Committee chairman, E. Kontz Bennett discussing outlook for the 1955 auction here and throughout the belt quote[illegible] re[illegible] B. [illegible] [illegible] [illegible]

CHARLOTTE OBSERVER, DECEMBER 9, 1971

Smoking Takes On A New Wrinkle

By PATRICIA McBROOM
Knight Newspapers Writer

A serious new hazard has been added to the list of cigarete dangers — wrinkling of the face.

In a California study of more than 1,000 people, cigarette smoking turned out to be major cause of crows feet and other wrinkles — more important than sun exposure, weight loss or anxiety, all events that have been linked with a lined face.

According to Dr. Harry W. Daniell, author of the study in Redding, Calif., smokers are much more apt to be wrinkled than non-smokers of the same age. Moreover, the smoker's wrinkles are deeper, longer and they come on earlier in life.

Habitual smokers in their 40s look like people 20 years older because of the wrinkles, said Daniell in an interview.

"And some of the smoking women in their late 30s are so heavily wrinkled, you would guess their age was 50," he said.

Daniell, a private physician, said he doesn't know why smoking cause wrinkles, but he believes it may have something to do with impaired blood circulation, resulting in a deficiency of oxygen in the tissues.

Nicotine is a known agent for constricting blood bessels, and Daniell speculated that wrinkles might be one consequence of this.

His report, published in the annals of Internal Medicine, is sure to be controversial because Daniell does not have direct proof that smoking causes wrinkles.

He has simply found a very strong association between smoking and wrinkling — the same kind of evidence that has established other hazards of cigarette smoking.

Daniell said the relation between smoking and wrinkling is so obvious that anyone can see it, although there are exceptions. Many smokers did not have excess wrinkles but they were in the minority.

THE CHARLOTTE OBSERVER, JANUARY 11, 1972

Surgeon General Proposes Making Safer Cigarettes

United Press International

WASHINGTON — Surgeon General Jesse L. Steinfeld has called for safe cigarettes for those Americans who can't quit and suggested for the first time that nonsmokers may suffer from inhaling someone else's smoke.

In the sixth Surgeon General's Report to Congress on the health consequences of smoking, Steinfeld said carbon monoxide in cigarette smoke may even be harmful to nearby nonsmokers, especially those with chronic lung and heart disease.

He also said it is too early to tell if a trend toward kicking the smoking habit has affected the national disease and death rate.

"In the past few years, millions of Americans have stopped smoking because they have persuaded themselves that it is in their own self-interest to do do; we must continue to encourage cessation as the only certain way to protect the individual and society from the harmful effects of smoking," the non-smoking Steinfeld wrote in a preface.

"We must also however work toward reducing the dangers of smoking for those who have not quit by developing less hazardous cigarettes and encouraging less hazardous ways of smoking," he added.

The smoker himself can diminish health hazards by reducing the number of cigarettes he smokes, how far down he smokes each cigarette and how frequently and deeply he inhales, Steinfeld said.

The report urged tobacco makers to help make smoking safer by reducing the harmful substances in cigarette smoke, starting with carbon monoxide, nicotine and tar.

The study, based on 1,500 scientific inquiries, said that "poisonous carbon monoxide" might even be harmful to nearby nonsmokers, especially those with chronic lung and heart disease.

He said there was enough evidence in the report to "support action to give the nonsmoker relief" from having to breathe smoke in public places.

TOBACCO,
OCTOBER 29, 1971

The Health Issue and Taxes

Taxes taking bigger bite than ever

Louisville, Ky.

This will not be a shrill lament against anti-tobacco partisans. I will try to keep this on a positive note. I want, however, to echo the thinking of Burley Auction Warehouseman H. I. (Hi) Miranda; "Identify and Testify." It is good. It makes sense for all in the tobacco community to be responsible and responsive.

I want to thank all who had a part in the success of the Tobacco Growers' Information Committee's educational campaign to encourage all U. S. growers to cut the amount of chemical residues. This drive is to insure the place of U. S. tobacco in world markets.

They received all-out cooperation from the tobacco specialists at nine land-grant colleges and universities on "editorial counseling" needed about chemical usage.

Growers were cautioned on chemical usage. They were told to use only approved chemicals—then *only* if the farmer could justify in dollars the need.

Speaking of dollars, the tax collectors are making their annual haul even bigger. It is a miracle of U. S. sales talent that however, 538-billion cigarettes were sold last year. Miraculous, yes, in spite of a 9.5 per cent increase in tax levies by States.

The 1970 State levies—this includes 200 municipali-

**This article was excerpted from the address by W. H. W. Anderson, managing director of the Tobacco Growers' Information Committee, Inc., before the annual meeting of the Burley and Dark Leaf Tobacco Export Assn., at Louisville, Ky., Sept. 27, 1971.*

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